an evening a n d night there. I could not avoid this passing visit a n d brief stay.

After a few days at Montreux I proceeded to Geneva a n d Marseilles, where I boarded the K . L . M . air liner for the East. On arrival in R o m e in the late afternoon, I was met by a high official who handed me a letter from the *Chef de Cabinet* of Signor Mussolini. T h e Duce, it stated, would be glad to meet me a n d he h a d fixed six o'clock that evening for the interview. I was surprised a n d reminded him of my previous messages. But he insisted that it h a d now all been fixed up and the arrangement could not be upset. Indeed if the interview did not take place there was every likelihood of his being dismissed f r o m his office. I was assured that nothing would appear in the press, a n d that I need only see the Duce, for a few minutes. All that he wanted to do was to shake hands with me a n d to convey personally his condolences at my wife's death. So we argued for a full hour with all courtesy on both sides but with increasing strain; it was a most exhausting hour for me and probably more so for the other party. T h e time fixed for the interview was at last upon us and I had my